

Don't respond to nasty messages. With the mobile phones and social networking sites ruling our lives, some immature individuals post nasty comments, send berating SMS messages and share humiliating pictures of videos.

Before you post something on the internet, pause for a minute and think over the contents. While sharing anything personal, be very conscious. Even if you know most of the people on your friend list personally, the information can be misused. It could be copied and made public, and once it's on the internet, it's very difficult to remove it later on.

It pays to be courteous online. Manners never hurt anyone and this is the same in the online forum. This starts by treating people like the way you would like to be treated. Being mean can only attract troubles and bigger bullies picking on you.

In case you come across unflattering statements or statements on the internet that makes you uncomfortable, just ignore it or better, block the sender from your list. Most bullies are encouraged by retaliation and the situation would only get worse thereon.

If you are being subjected to unwanted, abusive message, report this to an adult who you trust – your parents or a teacher. They would inform the service provider of the email or phone service and the bully can be taken to task. This will mean that the person who you confide in should take a broader perspective and take action immediately. If things still continue, inform the cybercrime division in your city. They would immediately get working on the culprit.

Before you approach the authorities, ensure that you have enough evidence. Save the messages or conversation thread on your social networking site. Again, get your parents or another adult into the picture. If this gets serious, approach the police.

If you see another person fall a victim to this behaviour, don't just watch. Encourage your friend or the person bullied to take action. Stand up for the victim. You can enlist your parent's help or even discuss this with your teacher. They would be able to take a call on this and safeguard you in case the issue turns vicious.

In conclusion

While the internet is a wonderful device and has become an imperceptible part of our lives, there's a lot out there that could cause serious trouble. The flip side is cybercrime and sadly, it is on the rise. The best thing to do is to